PORTFOLIO PROJECT · REAL DATA: PUBLIC ACCOUNTS OF CANADA, 2009/10 TO 2024/25

Did federal departments spend what they were given?

Original budget, final budget and actual spending for about 140 departments, fiscal years 2009/10 to 2024/25.

POWER BI · PORTFOLIO

Ministry: All

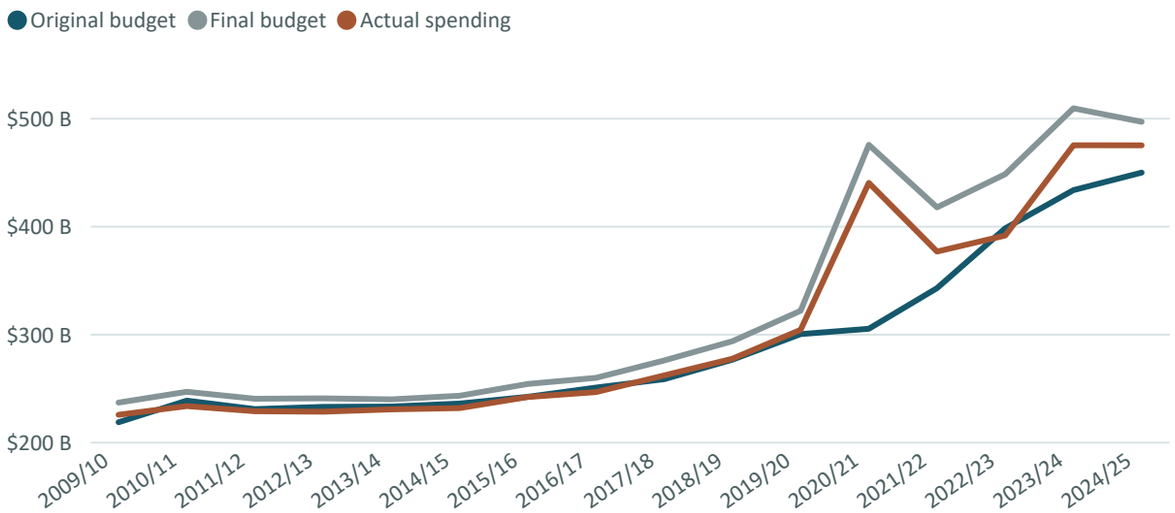
Fiscal year: 2024/25

Definitions: final budget = original budget (Main Estimates) plus mid-year additions, transfers and amounts carried in. Unspent = lapsed: neither spent nor carried forward. Status: under 5% unspent on track, 5-10% watch, over 10% attention.

Original budget	Final budget	Actual spending	Unspent	Unspent share	Spending change
Main Estimates	▲ $47.0 B in year	106% of original	4.0% of final budget	3-yr average 7.3%	vs 2023/24
$449.2 B	**$496.2 B**	**$474.4 B**	**$20.1 B**	**4.0%**	**0.0%**

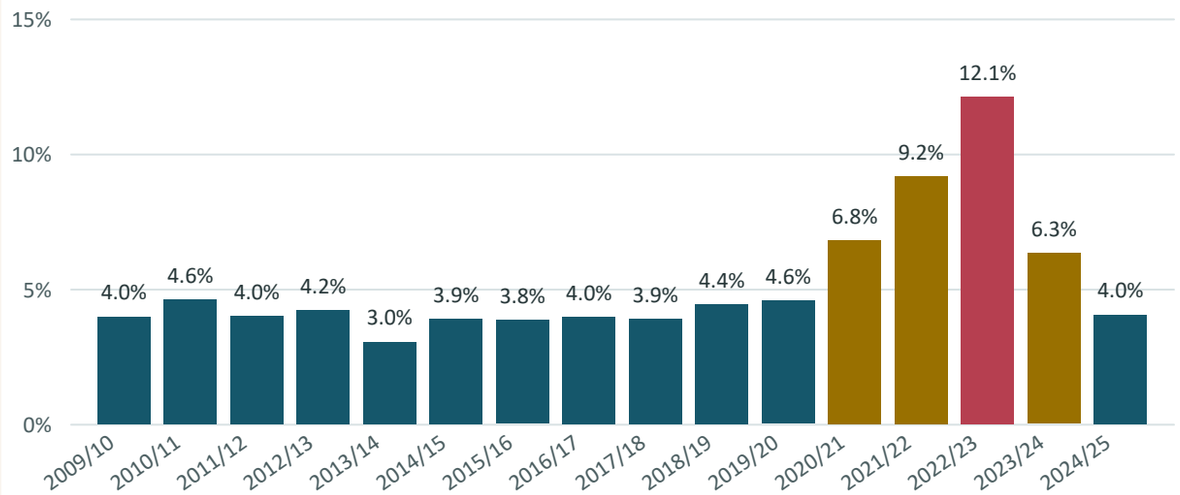
Original budget, final budget and actual spending

All years, $ billions. Ignores the year slicer.



Share of the final budget left unspent

All years. Blue = under 5%, ochre = 5-10%, red = over 10%. Ignores the year slicer.



Budget vs actual by ministry and department

Selected year, $ millions. Expand a ministry to see its departments. Status: under 5% unspent on track, 5-10% watch, over 10% attention; Treasury Board central votes lapse by design.

Ministry	Final budget	Actual	Unspent	Unspent %	3-yr avg	Status	Pattern
Crown-Indigenous Relations and Northern Affairs	$17,986 M	$14,286 M	$3,698 M	20.6%	32.4%	Attention	Recurring
Transport	$8,133 M	$5,920 M	$2,210 M	27.2%	28.5%	Attention	Recurring
Treasury Board	$13,173 M	$11,148 M	$2,013 M	15.3%	20.5%	By design	Central fund
Housing, Infrastructure and Communities	$16,467 M	$14,546 M	$1,921 M	11.7%	11.7%	Attention	Occasional
Innovation, Science and Industry	$14,465 M	$12,474 M	$1,742 M	12.0%	16.2%	Attention	Recurring
Public Safety	$16,560 M	$14,641 M	$1,718 M	10.4%	8.2%	Attention	Occasional
Health	$14,323 M	$12,762 M	$1,497 M	10.5%	21.7%	Attention	Recurring
Indigenous Services	$27,869 M	$26,483 M	$1,354 M	4.9%	20.7%	On track	
Energy and Natural Resources	$7,067 M	$6,187 M	$868 M	12.3%	12.3%	Attention	Occasional
National Defence	$35,858 M	$35,028 M	$816 M	2.3%	3.8%	On track	
Total	**$496,222 M**	**$474,431 M**	**$20,056 M**	**4.0%**	**7.3%**	**On track**	

What this means

1. Budget against the final number, not the original one. Since 2020 actual spending has run up to 44% above the original budget; the original budget alone no longer predicts the year.

2. Separate recurring underspending from occasional spikes. The post-COVID jump in unspent funds came from a few departments; recurring cases need program fixes, occasional spikes need timing fixes.

3. Read central funds differently. Treasury Board central votes are designed to lapse when not needed, so they are labelled rather than flagged.

PORTFOLIO PROJECT · REAL DATA: PUBLIC ACCOUNTS OF CANADA, 2009/10 TO 2024/25

Where did the money go?

A budget walk from the original budget to actual spending, the departments with the most unspent, and budget size against unspent share.

POWER BI · PORTFOLIO

Ministry

All

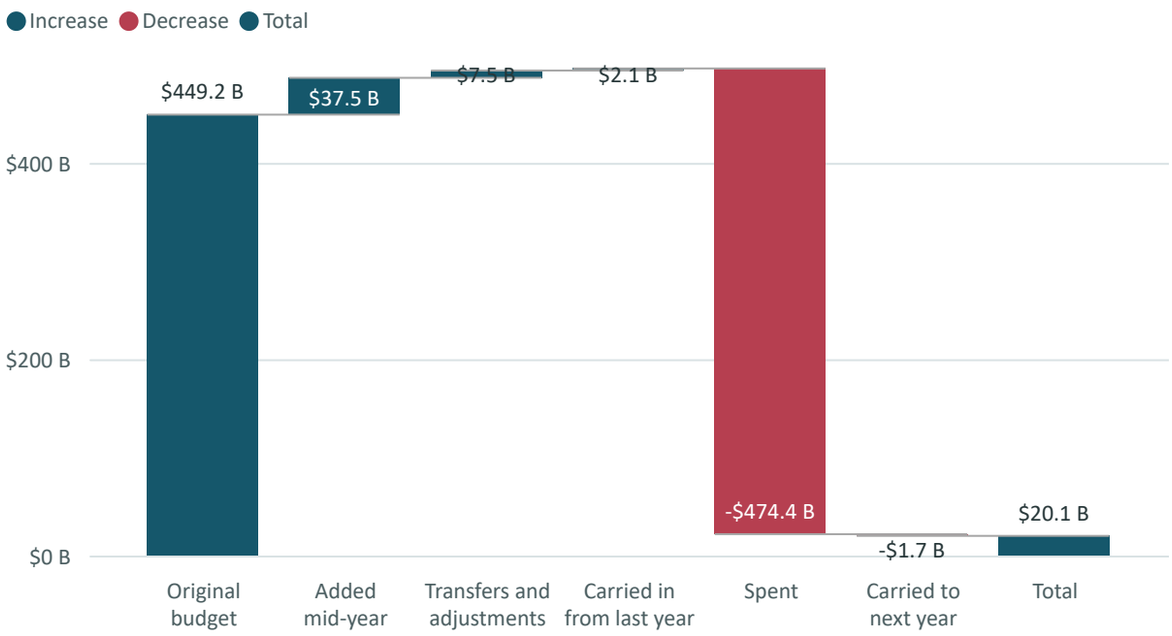
Fiscal year

2024/25

How to read: the budget walk starts at the original budget, adds money approved during the year, then takes away spending and amounts carried to next year; what is left is unspent. Selected year and ministries, $ billions.

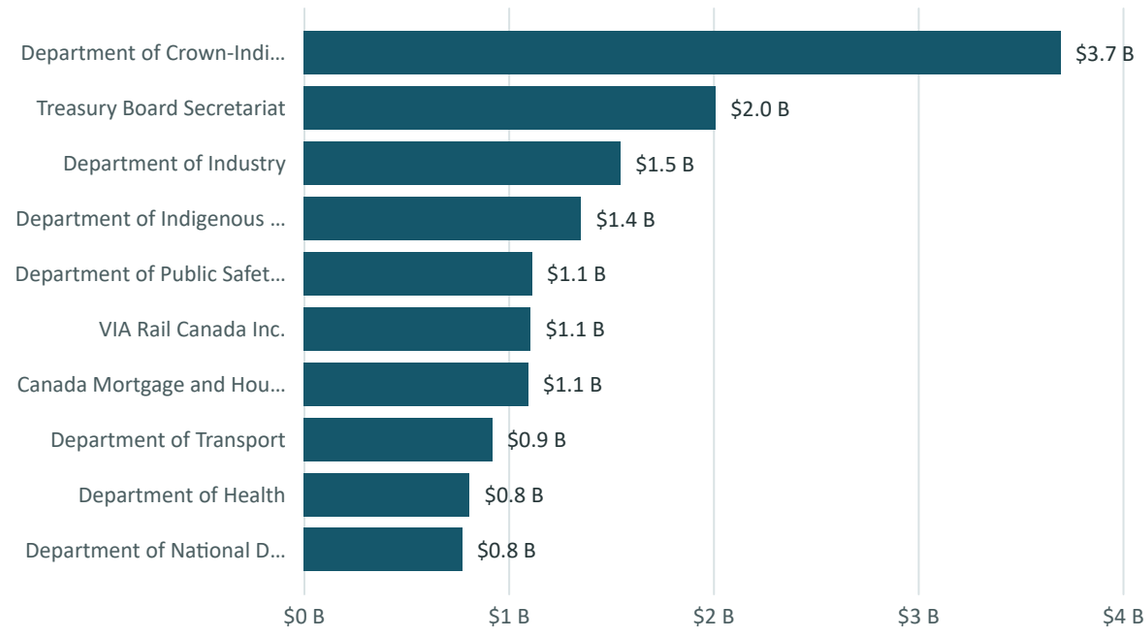
Budget walk: from original budget to unspent

Selected year and ministries, $ billions. The final bar is the amount left unspent.



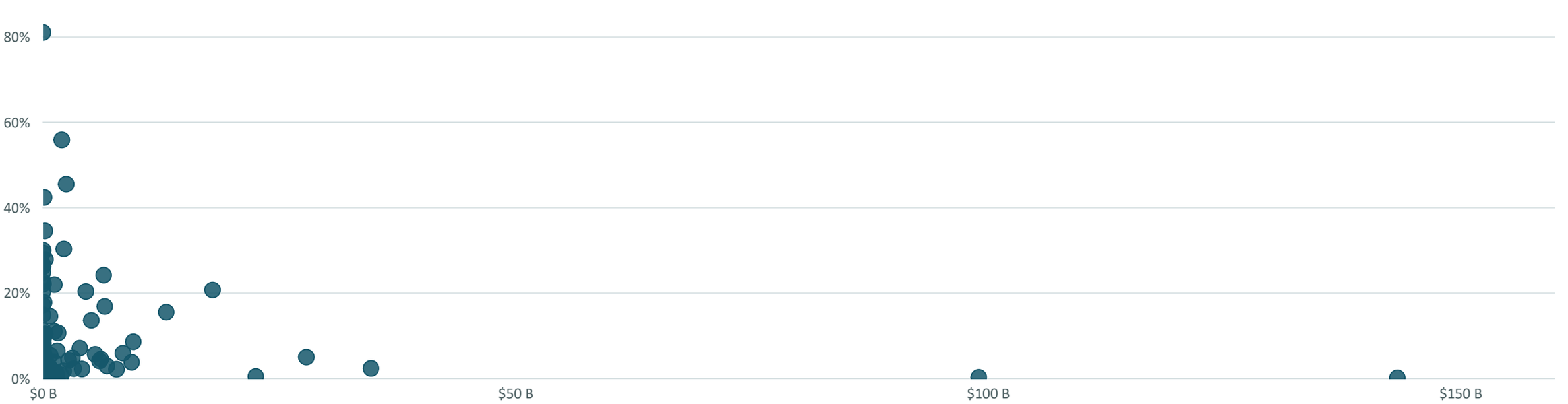
Departments with the most unspent

Top 10 in the selection, $ billions.



Budget size against share left unspent

Each dot is a department in the selected year. Large budgets with a high unspent share are the ones to review first.



How to read this page

Budget walk: original budget, plus funds added during the year, transfers and amounts carried in, minus spending and amounts carried forward, leaves the unspent amount.
Security: a Ministry manager role filters every page to the ministries assigned to the signed-in user (demo users in the Security table).
Source: Public Accounts of Canada, Source and Disposition of Authorities by Ministry (PSPC open data). Amounts in $ billions, rounded.